

flea

NEWS 69 *December 2011*



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FLEA NEWS is a biannual newsletter about fleas (Siphonaptera). Recipients are urged to check any citations given here before including them in publications. Many of our sources are abstracting journals and current literature sources such as National Agricultural Library (NAL) Agricola, and National Library of Medicine (NLM) Medline, and citations have not necessarily been checked for accuracy or consistent formatting.

Recipients are urged to contribute items of interest to the profession for inclusion herein, including: Flea research citations from journals that are not indexed in Agricola or Medline databases, Announcements and Requests for material, Contact information for a Directory of Siphonapterists (name, mailing address, email address, and areas of interest - Systematics, Ecology, Control, etc.), Abstracts of research planned or in progress, Book reviews, Biography, Hypotheses and Literature Reviews, and Anecdotes. Send to:

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Contents

Editorial
 Announcements
 Meetings
 Presentations
 Featured research
 Fleas in art and history
 Directory of Siphonapterists (updated)
 Siphonaptera Literature July – December 2011

Editorial

Dear Flea News Reader,

Although the thrust of Flea News continues to emphasize scientific and technical papers on Siphonaptera, in this volume the editors feature a sample from the cultural history of the flea ("Fleas in Art and History"). Fleas have had a long intimacy with humans, and so have inspired numerous creations in art, history, literature, music, and poetry.

On different subject, I wanted to explain that the databases used for creating each volume of Flea News bibliography often change in availability. This means that there is often variability in thoroughness of coverage, and formatting. The contents of certain journals are unavailable, or delayed in listing.

Similarly, databases often have their own formatting of citations. Oftentimes, processing these references introduces errors, such as rearranging the order of authors, or removing information such as the author, in which case, the editor may list the citation as 'anonymous'. Sometimes computer indexing numbers (for example, PubMed 'PMID') are included in the references, but not always. Unfortunately, it is impossible for the editors to check whether the citations are accurate or not, so, as stated in previous volumes, readers should check any references listed in Flea News with the original sources.

That is why any contributions from Flea News readers on literature, the editors so appreciate. We appreciate all our readers. Our goal remains to refer to all things Siphonapteran, which is a large task.

R.L. Bossard, Editor, Flea News

Announcements

Now that you have your 2012 calendar up, I wanted to remind you that the 2012 Livestock Insect Workers Conference will be held June 24-27, at the Red Lion Inn in Kalispell, Montana.

Hosts and organizers are Tim Lysyk (Lethbridge Research Centre, Alberta, Canada, Tim.Lysyk@agr.gc.ca) and Greg Johnson (Montana State Univ., gdj@montana.edu). They will be providing us with information on the meeting in a couple of months and the call for submissions will come out in March or April. Meanwhile, be sure to block out this week and plan to attend.

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Please join us this June for the 62nd annual meeting of the James Steele Conference on Diseases in Nature Transmissible to Man that will convene June 20-22, 2012 at the Crowne Plaza Riverwalk Hotel, 111 E. Pecan St., San Antonio, TX 78205. The conference focuses on zoonotic diseases, environmental diseases, and biosecurity. The Call for Papers Submission Deadline is March 2, 2012.

(<http://www.crowneplaza.com/hotels/us/en/san-antonio/satps/hoteldetail>).
<http://sites.google.com/site/diseasesinnature/>

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The International Conference on Diseases in Nature Communicable to Man 67th meeting will be held from July 22-24, 2012 in Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada.
<http://sites.google.com/site/incdncm/Home>

"The local organizing committee from the Public Health Agency of Canada's National Microbiology Laboratory will be hosting the meeting focused on the interface of diseases that affect wildlife and humans. INCDNCM has been held annually since 1946 and has a long history of fostering collaborations among universities, health institutions, and other public agencies.

This year's meeting will include keynote talks in disease epidemiology and genetics and general paper and poster sessions. A strength of INCDNCM is the broad variety of topics its participants share each year. This includes surveys of pathogens in wildlife, evolution of virulence, vector and pathogen ecology, control efforts, host shifts, emerging infectious diseases, food and waterborne pathogens, pathogen genetics and genomics, and much more."

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Presentations

Flea-related papers presented at the 2011 - 66th INCDNCM (International Conference on Diseases in Nature Communicable to Man) Meeting, Northern Arizona University, Flagstaff, Arizona, held on July 24-27th:

R.R. Parker Memorial Address:

"Mechanisms of Flea-borne Transmission of *Yersinia pestis*: Some New (and Old) Questions about Plague Ecology".

B. Joseph Hinnebusch, Chief of Plague Section, NIH_NIAID, Laboratory of Zoonotic Pathogens. jhinnebusch@niaid.nih.gov

Keynote Lecture:

"Microbial Forensics and its Relationship to Molecular Epidemiology: Examples from Anthrax, Cholera, and Plague".

Paul Keim, Center for Microbial Genetics and Genomics, Northern Arizona University, Flagstaff, Arizona.

GENE EXPRESSION ANALYSIS OF *XENOPSYLLA CHEOPIS* FLEAS SUGGESTS A ROLE FOR REACTIVE OXYGEN SPECIES IN RESPONSE TO *YERSINIA PESTIS* INFECTION. NICHOLAS J. WHIPPLE, Wei Zhou, Kody L. Johnson, Richard D. Mortensen, and David L. Erickson.

DEVELOPING GENETIC MARKERS FOR FLEAS THAT VECTOR PLAGUE (*YERSINIA PESTIS*).

BRET CLAWSON, Joseph D. Busch, Rebecca E. Colman, Michael W. Versteeg, Christopher Allender, Jeff Foster, Paul Keim, David M. Wagner.

APPLICATION OF REAL-TIME QUANTITATIVE-PCR ON *YERSINIA PESTIS* IN FLEAS FROM A PRAIRIE DOG EPIZOOTIC EVENT.

REBECCA E. COLMAN, Adina L. Doyle, Christopher J. Allender, Derek S. Sarovich, Jessica M. Girard, Amy J. Vogler, Paul Keim, and David M. Wagner.

PHYLOGENETIC RELATIONSHIPS AMONG POPULATIONS OF THE PRIMARY ARTHROPOD VECTOR OF PLAGUE TO HUMANS, *OROPSYLLA MONTANA*, IN THE UNITED STATES.

SCOTT A. BERNHARDT, William C. Black IV, John A. Montenieri, Ken L. Gage.

PLAGUE PREVENTION, MANAGEMENT AND CONTROL IN UGANDA.

KENNETH L. GAGE, Jeff N. Borchert, Rebecca J. Eisen, Russell E. Ensore, Joseph Tendo, Linda A. Atiku, Nackson Babi, John Montenieri, Karen Boegler, Katie MacMillan, and Charles B. Beard.

PHYLOGEOGRAPHY AND SUBTYPING OF *COXIELLA BURNETII*.

TALIMA PEARSON, Heidie M. Hornstra, Lauren T. Gates, Remy Hilsabeck, James Cook, Carina Hall, Rachael A. Priestley, Gilbert J. Kersh, Robert F. Massung, and Paul Keim.

IDENTIFICATION OF *BARTONELLA* ENDOCARDITIS CASES IN THAILAND.

MICHAEL KOSOY, Ying Bai, Nordin Zeidner, Christopher Paddock, Orathai Pachirat, Leonard Peruski, Sumalee Boonmar, George Watt.

COMPARISON OF VIRULENCE IN *YERSINIA PESTIS* ISOLATES FROM NORTH AMERICA.

JOSEPH D. BUSCH, Roger van Andel, Roxanne Nottingham, Carina Hall, Scott Bearden, Kenneth L. Gage, Richard Bowen, Paul Keim, Dave Wagner.

PHYLOGEOGRAPHY AND MOLECULAR EPIDEMIOLOGY OF *YERSINIA PESTIS* IN MADAGASCAR.

AMY J. VOGLER, Fabien Chan, David M. Wagner, Philippe Roumagnac, Judy Lee, Roxanne Nera, Mark Eppinger, Jacques Ravel, Lila Rahalison, Bruno W. Rasoamanana, Stephen M. Beckstrom-Sternberg, Mark Achtman, Suzanne Chanteau, Paul Keim.

EVALUATION OF THE INFECTIOUSNESS TO MICE OF SOIL CONTAMINATED WITH *YERSINIA PESTIS*-INFECTED BLOOD.

KAREN A. BOEGLER, Christine B. Graham, John A. Montenieri, Katherine MacMillan, Jennifer L. Holmes, Jeannine M. Petersen, Kenneth L. Gage, and Rebecca J. Eisen.

Remarkably, there were no papers found on Siphonaptera at the 2011 ESA Annual Meeting (November 13-16, 2011).

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Michael W. Hastriter. 2009. Book Review - Functional and Evolutionary Ecology of Fleas. *Journal of Medical Entomology* 46(3): 716.

Boris R. Krasnov, Cambridge University Press, New York, 2008, 593 pp., ISBN: 978-0-521-88277-4

"This welcome volume is a one of a kind publication, steering away from the traditional empirical approaches to host/parasite relationships used by classical flea systematists. The ecology of the Order Siphonaptera has been grossly neglected from the onset of flea systematics that began in earnest in the early 1900s with the recognition of the flea's role in transmission of human diseases. Relative to the abundant α -taxonomic publications of the past century, there were few works on the ecology and bionomics fleas. Dr. Krasnov has addressed most of the significant ecological and bionomic contributions of others in this book and cleverly assembled and integrated them with his immense personal knowledge of the functional ecology of fleas. Knowledge of the evolutionary and phylogenetic assessments of the order Siphonaptera, based mostly on cladistical methodologies, was accurately reflected at the time of its writing; however, with the emergence of state-of-the-art DNA technologies, a more current and accurate assessment of the classification schemes presented has been published (Whiting et al. 2008)." (Excerpted by editor)

Featured research

Takashi Nagata, Mitsumasa Koyanagi, Hisao Tsukamoto, Shinjiro Saeki, Kunio Isono, Yoshinori Shichida, Fumio Tokunaga, Michiyo Kinoshita, Kentaro Arikawa, and Akihisa Terakita. 2012. Depth Perception from Image Defocus in a Jumping Spider. *Science* 27 January 2012: 335 (6067), 469-471. [DOI:10.1126/science.1211667]

The principal eyes of jumping spiders have a unique retina with four-tiered photoreceptor layers, on each of which light of different wavelengths is focused by a lens with appreciable chromatic

aberration. We found that all photoreceptors in both the deepest and second-deepest layers contain a green-sensitive visual pigment, although green light is only focused on the deepest layer. This mismatch indicates that the second-deepest layer always receives defocused images, which contain depth information of the scene in optical theory. Behavioral experiments revealed that depth perception in the spider was affected by the wavelength of the illuminating light, which affects the amount of defocus in the images resulting from chromatic aberration. Therefore, we propose a depth perception mechanism based on how much the retinal image is defocused.

Brencicova, Eva. 2012. How jumping spiders make a perfect jump. Cosmos Online, 27 January 2012. <http://www.cosmosmagazine.com/news/5223/how-jumping-spiders-make-a-perfect-jump>

"A reliable three-dimensional perception of the world is crucial for an animal's successful hunting and mating behaviour, and ultimately its survival. The most common way an animal gauges an object's distance is by either adjusting the focal length of the lenses in its eyes or moving its head to shift images on the retina. A new study published in Science today suggests that jumping spiders use a third option to achieve the perfect jump." (Excerpted by editor)

Naumann DN, Baird-Clarke CD, Ross DA. 2011. Fleas on operations in Afghanistan--environmental health measures on the front line. J R Army Med Corps 157(3):226-8.

Flea bites can cause irritating symptoms, secondary infections, and may potentiate the spread of vector-borne disease. Flea infestation and bites may also cause significant psychological distress, and can reduce the morale and fighting fitness of deployed military personnel. The problem of flea infestation was highlighted during Op HERRICK 12 in two 'front line' Check Points (CPs) where the entire population of soldiers suffered from multiple symptoms due to flea infestation and bites. Several attempts at infestation control initially succeeded but later led to recurrence. Such failure was due to the incomplete killing of all stages of the flea life cycle, and due to constraints on education, training, communication, and resupply in the isolated and austere environment of the CPs. A dedicated operation (designated Op Insecticide) was put into action in order to eradicate the problem and return the affected troops back to full fighting fitness. Op Insecticide was thorough, systematic and sustainable, and led to an eradication of the flea infestation problem at the affected CPs.

LESLIE, T., C. A. WHITEHOUSE, S. YINGST, C. BALDWIN, F. KAKAR, J. MOFLEH, A. S. HAMI, L. MUSTAFA, F. OMAR, E. AYAZI, C. ROSSI, B. NOORMAL, N. ZIAR, and R. KAKAR. 2011. Outbreak of gastroenteritis caused by *Yersinia pestis* in Afghanistan. Epidemiology and Infection 139: 728-735.

Plague, which is most often caused by the bite of *Yersinia pestis*-infected fleas, is a rapidly progressing, serious disease that can be fatal without prompt antibiotic treatment. In late December 2007, an outbreak of acute gastroenteritis occurred in Nimroz Province of southern Afghanistan. Of the 83 probable cases of illness, 17 died (case fatality 20.5%). Being a case was

associated with consumption or handling of camel meat (adjusted odds ratio 4.4, 95% confidence interval 2.2–8.8, $P < 0.001$). Molecular testing of patient clinical samples and of tissue from the camel using PCR/electrospray ionization–mass spectrometry revealed DNA signatures consistent with *Yersinia pestis*. Confirmatory testing using real-time PCR and immunological seroconversion of one of the patients confirmed that the outbreak was caused by plague, with a rare gastrointestinal presentation. The study highlights the challenges of identifying infectious agents in low-resource settings; it is the first reported occurrence of plague in Afghanistan.

Acosta R. 2010. Five new Mexican species of the flea genus *Strepsylla* Traub, 1950 (Siphonaptera: Ctenophthalmidae: Neopsyllinae: Phalacropsyllini) with a phylogenetic analysis. *Journal of Parasitology*, 96(2): 285-298.

Acosta R. 2011. Distributional data and taxonomic notes on the flea *Strepsylla* (Siphonaptera: Ctenophthalmida: Neopsylla: Phalacropsyllini). *Revista Mexicana de Biodiversidad*, 82: 1154 – 1162.

Acosta R., B. Salceda-Sánchez and H. E. Ponce-Ulloa. 2009. Two new species of the fleas (Kohlsia Traub, 1950 (Siphonaptera: Ceratophyllidae) from Mexico. *Zootaxa*, 2224: 60 – 68.

Acosta, R. and J. A. Fernández. 2009. A new species of *Anomyopsyllus* (Insecta: Siphonaptera), and noteworthy records of fleas from Nelson's woodrat, *Neotoma nelsoni* (Rodentia: Cricetidae) in the Oriental Basin, Mexico. *Journal of Parasitology*, 95(3): 532–535.

Falcón-Ordaz J., R. Acosta, J. A. Fernández y G. Lira-Guerrero. 2012. Helminths and siphonapterans parasites of five species of rodents in localities of the Cuenca Oriental, in the center of Mexico. *Acta Zoológica Mexicana (nueva serie)*, 28(2).

Montiel-Arteaga, A., R. Acosta, G. Ceballos, and G. Suzan. 2010. Flea community and prevalence of *Yersinia pestis* in black-tailed prairie dogs (*Cynomys ludovicianus*) from northwestern Mexico. *Vector-Borne and Zoonotic Diseases*, 10 (1): 101.

Suzan G., A. de Villa-Meza, C. Muñoz, R. Avila-Flores, R. Acosta, E. Rivera, E. Rendon, and G. Ceballos. 2010. Seasonal and spatial changes in flea communities of black-tailed prairie dogs of northwestern Mexico. *Vector-Borne and Zoonotic Diseases*, 10 (1): 102-103.

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Beaucournu J.-C., 2011- La peste noire et le rôle des puces (suite). *Quey'Racines*, n°9, 23-25.

Beaucournu J.-C., 2011- La peste noire et le rôle des puces (fin). *Quey'Racines*, n°10, 7-9.

Beaucournu J.-C., 2011- Contribution à une meilleure connaissance des genres *Ctenophthalmus* Kolenati, 1856, et *Stenoponia*, Jordan & Rothschild, 1911 (Siphonaptera, Ctenophthalmidae). *Bulletin de la Société entomologique de France*, 116, 57-61.

Beaucournu J.-C., Moreno L. & Gonzalez-Acuna D., 2011- Deux espèces nouvelles de puces (Siphonaptera: Ctenophthalmidae & Rhopalopsyllidae) du Chili. *Parasite*, 18, 241-246.

Beaucournu J.-C. & Wells K., 2011- *Gryphopsylla segregata* Beaucournu & Sountsov, 1999 : nouveau statut pour *G. jacobsoni segregata*, description de la femelle et proposition d'une clé pour le genre *Gryphopsylla* Traub, 1957 (Siphonaptera - Pygiopsyllidae - Stivaliinae). *Parasite*, 18, 247-250.

Beaucournu J.-C., Mergey T. & Gonzalez-Acuna D., 2011- Un accident rarissime : rupture du phallosome dans les voies génitales de la femelle (Siphonaptera). *Bulletin de la Société entomologique de France*, 116, 501-503.

Beaucournu J.-C., Meheretu J., Welegerima K., Mergey T. & Laudisoit A. - Description de *Nosopsyllus* (*N.*) *atsbi* n. sp. (Siphonaptera : Ceratophyllidae) d'Ethiopie et révision de l'espèce affine *N. (N.) incisus* (Jordan & Rothschild, 1913); discussion biogéographique. *Parasite*, 19, (31-40, à paraître, 2012).

Beaucournu J.-C., Mergey T., Munoz-Leal S. & Gonzalez-Acuna D.- Description de *Tunga bonneti* n. sp. du Chili (Insecta - Siphonaptera - Tungidae) et notes sur sa spécificité, sa chorologie, son dermecos et sa phénologie. *Parasite*, soumis.

Perrichot V., Velten J., Beaucournu J.-C. First extinct genus of a flea (Siphonaptera: Pulicidae) in amber from the Dominican Republic. *Zootaxa*, (à paraître, 2012).

Beaucournu J.-C., Munoz-Leal S. & Gonzalez-Acuna D.- *Dasypsyllus patagonicus* n. sp. puce nouvelle du sud du Chili. *Bulletin de la Société entomologique de France*, 117, (à paraître, 2012).

Laudisoit A., Prié V & Beaucournu J.-C.- Note sur les Ischnopsyllinae de la région afrotropicale, V : Une nouvelle espèce de *Lagaropsylla* Jordan & Rothschild, 1921 de Madagascar (Insecta-Siphonaptera-Ischnopsyllidae). *Zoosystema*, 2012, sous presse.

Lemaire J.-M. & Beaucournu J.-C.- Une localité nouvelle et un hôte nouveau pour la puce d'oiseau *Ceratophyllus vagabundus alpestris* Jordan, 1926 (Siphonaptera, Ceratophyllidae). *Biocosme*, sous presse.

Wells K., Lakim M.B. & Beaucournu J.-C., 2011- Host specificity and niche partitioning in flea-small mammal networks in Bornean rainforests. *Med Vet Entomol.* Sep; 25(3):311-9, doi; 10.1111/j. 1365-2915.2010.00940.x

The diversity of ectoparasites in Southeast Asia and flea-host associations remain largely understudied. We explore specialization and interaction patterns of fleas infesting non-volant small mammals in Bornean rainforests, using material from a field survey carried out in two montane localities in northwestern Borneo (Sabah, Malaysia) and from a literature database of all available interactions in both lowland and montane forests. A total of 234 flea individuals collected during our field survey resulted in an interaction network of eight flea species on seven

live-captured small mammal species. The interaction network from all compiled studies currently includes 15 flea species and 16 small mammal species. Host specificity and niche partitioning of fleas infesting diurnal treeshrews and squirrels were low, with little difference in specialization among taxa, but host specificity in lowland forests was found to be higher than in montane forests. By contrast, *Sigmactenus alticola* (Siphonaptera: Leptopsyllidae) exhibited low host specificity by infesting various montane and lowland nocturnal rats. However, this species exhibited low niche partitioning as it was the only commonly recorded flea from rats on Borneo. Overall complementary specialization was of intermediate intensity for both networks and differed significantly from random association; this has important implications for specific interactions that are also relevant to the potential spread of vector-borne diseases.

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Dryden MW, Carithers D, Murray MJ. Flea Control: Real Homes, Real Problems, Real Answers, Real Lessons: Fleas in a Flash! Published on-line <http://www.vetlearn.com/compendium/flea-control-real-cases-fleas-in-a-flash> Compendium, April 2011 (Vol. 33, No 4).

Dryden MW, Carithers D, Murray MJ. Flea Control: Real Homes, Real Problems, Real Answers, Real Lessons: Where Are All These Fleas Coming From? Published on-line <http://www.vetlearn.com/compendium/flea-control-real-cases-where-are-all-these-fleas-coming-from> Compendium, May 2011 (Vol. 33, No 5).

Dryden MW, Carithers D, Murray MJ. Flea Control: Real Homes, Real Problems, Real Answers, Real Lessons: Hitchhiker Fleas and the Indoor-Only Cats. Published on-line <http://www.vetlearn.com/compendium/flea-control-real-cases-fleas-in-a-flash> Compendium, June 2011 (Vol. 33, No 6).

Dryden MW, Carithers D, Murray MJ. Flea Control: Real Homes, Real Problems, Real Answers, Real Lessons: The "Deep Dive". Published on-line <http://www.vetlearn.com/compendium/flea-control-real-cases-the-deep-dive> Compendium, July 2011 (Vol. 33, No 7).

Dryden MW, Carithers D, Murray MJ. Flea Control: Real Homes, Real Problems, Real Answers, Real Lessons: The What? Published on-line <http://www.vetlearn.com/compendium/flea-control-real-cases-the-what> Compendium, August 2011 (Vol. 33, No 8).

Dryden MW, Payne PA, Vicki S, Kobuszewski D. 2011. Efficacy of Topically Applied Dinotefuran Formulations and Orally Administered Spinosad Tablets Against the KS1 Flea Strain Infesting dogs. Intern J Appl Res Vet Med 9(2): 123-128, 2011.

Dryden MW, Payne PA, Vicki S, Riggs B, Davenport J, Kobuszewski D. 2011. Efficacy of dinotefuran–pyriproxyfen, dinotefuran–pyriproxyfen–permethrin and fipronil–(S)-methoprene topical spot-on formulations to control flea populations in naturally infested pets and private residences in Tampa Florida. Vet Parasitol 182: 281– 286, 2011

Dryden MW, Payne PA, Smith V and Hostetler J. 2011. Efficacy of Imidacloprid + Moxidectin and Selamectin topical solutions against the KS1 *Ctenocephalides felis* flea strain infesting cats. *Parasites & Vectors* 4:174, 2011.

Müller GC, Dryden MW, Revay EE, Kravchenko VD, Broce AC, Hampton K, Junnila A, Schlein Y. 2011. Understanding attraction stimuli of *Ctenocephalides felis* for non-chemical control methods. *Med Vet Entomol.* 2011 Jul 25. doi: 10.1111/j.1365-2915.2011.00960.

Dryden M, Carithers D, McBride A, Riggs B, Smith L, Davenport J, Smith V, Payne P, Gross S. 2011. A comparison of flea control measurement methods for tracking flea populations in highly infested private residences in Tampa FL, following topical treatment of pets with FRONTLINE® Plus (fipronil/(S)-methoprene). *Intern J Appl Res Vet Med* 9(4): 356-367, 2011

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Hernández-Valdivia, Emmanuel, Carlos Cruz-Vázquez, Raúl Ortiz-Martínez, Arturo Valdivia-Flores, and Ma. Teresa Quintero-Martínez. 2011. Presence of *Ctenocephalides canis* (Curtis) and *Ctenocephalides felis* (Bouché) Infesting Dogs in the City of Aguascalientes, México. *Journal of Parasitology*: December 2011, Vol. 97, No. 6, pp. 1017-1019.

Prevalence and seasonal distribution of *Ctenocephalides canis* (Curtis) and *Ctenocephalides felis* (Bouché) infestations in urban dogs of the city of Aguascalientes, Mexico, were studied. Between January and December 2007, 863 dogs in the Municipal Canine and Feline Control Center were examined. Overall prevalence of infestation was 12% (95% CI 10–14). Seasonal distribution revealed that prevalences in spring and summer were highest, while autumn and winter had lower prevalences. Two infestation peaks were observed, i.e., in April (17.7%) and July (18.9%). A positive correlation was detected between prevalence and temperature during the winter season ($P < 0.05$). Prevalence in relation to gender showed that males were more frequently infested, 14% (95% CI 11–17), than females, 9.4% (95% CI 7–13); hair length did not affect differences in prevalence. Six hundred twenty-nine fleas were examined; 62% were *C. canis* and 38% *C. felis*. Dogs infested with only *C. canis* were 48% (95% CI 38–58), while 18% were infested only with *C. felis* (95% CI 11–27); the remainder, 34% (95% CI 24–44), had mixed infestations.

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Lareschi, Marcela, Analía G. Autino, M. Mónica Díaz, and Rubén M. Barquez. 2011. Taxonomy and Distribution of *Nonnapsylla* Wagner, 1938 (Siphonaptera: Stephanocircidae: Craneopsyllinae). *J. Parasitol.*, 97(5), pp. 954–955.

Lareschi, Marcela, Juliana P. Sanchez, M. Cecilia Ezquiaga, Analía G. Autino, M. Mónica Díaz, and Rubén M. Barquez. 2010. Fleas Associated with Mammals from Northwestern Argentina, with New Distributional Reports. *Comp. Parasitol.* 77(2), 2010, pp. 207–213.

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Lemoine M, Doligez B, Richner H. 2011. On the equivalence of host local adaptation and parasite maladaptation: an experimental test. *The American Naturalist* 179(2): 270-281.

In spatiotemporally varying environments, host-parasite coevolution may lead to either host or parasite local adaptation. Using reciprocal infestations over 11 pairs of plots, we tested local adaptation in the hen flea and its main host, the great tit. Flea reproductive success (number of adults at host fledging) was lower on host individuals from the same plot compared with foreign hosts (from another plot), revealing flea local maladaptation. Host reproductive success (number of fledged young) for nests infested by foreign fleas was lower compared with the reproductive success of controls, with an intermediate success for nests infested by local fleas. This suggests host local adaptation although the absence of local adaptation could not be excluded. However, fledglings were heavier and larger when reared with foreign fleas than when reared with local fleas, which could also indicate host local maladaptation if the fitness gain in offspring size offsets the potential cost in offspring number. Our results therefore challenge the traditional view that parasite local maladaptation is equivalent to host local adaptation. The differences in fledgling morphology between nests infested with local fleas and those with foreign fleas suggest- that flea origin affects host resource allocation strategy between nestling growth and defense against parasites. Therefore, determining the mechanisms that underlie these local adaptation patterns requires the identification of the relevant fitness measures and life-history trade-offs in both species.

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De Avelar, D. M., Linhares, A. X. and P. M. Linardi. 2012. A new species of *Tunga* (Siphonaptera: Tungidae) from Brazil with a key to the adult species and neosomes. Journal of Medical Entomology 49, (1): 23-28.

De Avelar, D. M., Melo, M. N. and P. M. Linardi. 2011. Morphology and growth characteristics of cultured *Leptomonas ctenocephali* from *Ctenocephalides felis felis* (Siphonaptera: Pulicidae) of dogs in Brazil. Veterinary Parasitology 180: 394-398.

To confirm the taxonomic identification of a trypanosomatid found in the hindgut, rectum and Malpighian tubules of dog fleas captured in Belo Horizonte, Minas Gerais, Brazil, between April and November of 2005, 910 specimens of *Ctenocephalides felis felis* were removed from street dogs and dissected, and isolates from their digestive tracts were cultivated in NNN-alpha-MEM medium. Four different morphological forms were observed in culture: long, slender, twisted promastigotes with a long flagellum; short, stubby, non-twisted promastigotes; rounded amastigotes; and cyst-like bodies. Twisted and non-twisted promastigotes were frequently seen forming rosettes, and these two forms presented significant differences ($P < 0.01$) in terms of their morphological characteristics. Unlike the promastigote forms observed throughout the culture period, rounded amastigotes were seen only in the lag phase, and the cyst-like bodies were only seen in the decline phase. The trypanosomatid DNA obtained from the culture was analyzed by the polymerase chain reaction (PCR) method and found to be negative for *Leishmania infantum chagasi*. Based on the growth pattern, morphological parameters and molecular analysis, the flagellates were confirmed to be *Leptomonas ctenocephali*. The significance of this infection for animals is also commented.

Esquiaga, M. C., Lareschi, M., De Avelar, D. M. and P. M. Linardi. 2011. Distribución geográfica y hospedatoria de la asociación entre dasipódidos (Xenarthra: Dasipodidae) y

espécies del género *Tunga* Jarocki (Siphonaptera: Tungidae) en la Argentina. Resúmenes XXIV Jornadas Argentinas de Mastozoología, La Plata, p. 92.

Linardi, P. M. Pulgas. 2011. In: C. B. Marcondes (Ed.) Entomologia Médica e Veterinária. São Paulo: Editora Atheneu, p. 249-277.

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Although on-animal topical treatment with compounds such as imidacloprid has revolutionized the control of the cat flea, *Ctenocephalides felis* (Bouché) (Siphonaptera: Pulicidae), the development of insecticide resistance is a continuing threat. As part of a highly co-ordinated and unprecedented resistance monitoring programme for *C. felis*, 1437 flea isolates were collected by veterinary clinics in Australia, Germany, France, the U.K. and 29 states in the U.S.A. from 2002 to 2009. About 65% of the collections were made from June to October each year and 71% of the collections were from cats. Collections of flea eggs were sent to one of five different laboratories, where they were tested with a diagnostic dose of imidacloprid (3 p.p.m.) applied to larval flea-rearing medium. Of the 1437 collections received, 1064 contained adequate numbers of eggs for testing. Of these isolates, untreated eggs failed to hatch in 22.7% and were not considered valid bioassays. Survival rates >5% and development of adult fleas (a threshold for further testing) occurred in only 22 isolates. They were re-tested with the same diagnostic dose and none produced >5% adult emergence. Complete dose–response bioassays were performed on three of the isolates that had triggered a second test and produced slopes, intercepts and LC50 values similar to those for existing susceptible laboratory strains. Results confirmed sustained susceptibility of *C. felis* to imidacloprid, despite its widespread use for over a decade.

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Fleas in Art and History

"The general fortunes of Roche mirror those of other monastic houses: a time of growth and prosperity in the 12th and first half of the 13th century was followed by a period of gradual decline that began with the arrival of a few rats and their fleas. Despite their isolation, the Black Death hit the population at Roche, and they never recovered. Although we do not know the precise numbers of those who died at Roche, we do know that four abbots presided at Kirkstall during the seven years from the outbreak of the Black Death, and that the nearby abbey at Meaux lost three-quarters of its brothers."

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"Circus proprietors related how they dealt with constant turnover of their short-lived casts and sometimes encountered customs problems when ordering special fleas from exotic places. Some demonstrated how they let their performers feed regularly on their forearms, and transported them from gig to gig in custom-built luggage. So historically, yes--there have been fleas in flea circuses, though whether they were engaged at the high levels of athletic and terpsichorean skill alleged by their owners is arguable."

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"Lying on boards, I am a captive beast among vermin,
the fleas renew their siege but the flies have at last retired.
Evening has come; my captivity, behold, is curtailed
by a day and so is my life. The camp is asleep. The moonshine
lights up the land and highlights the taut barbed wire fence,
it draws the shadow of armed prison guards, seen through the window,
walking, projected on walls, as they spy the night's early noises."

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